Title	**Law and Society**	Number	LAL3040
Department	HSS	L-T-P [C]	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	UG	Type	Elective
Prerequisite	None		

Objectives

1. To help students understand history of law and jurisprudence
2. To help students understand how law works, and what is illegality

Learning Outcomes

The students are expected to have the ability to:

1. Know what sociology of law means and understand the place of law in society
2. Ability to critically analyse current events from the perspective of sociology of law
3. Understand the workings of law framework in India

Contents

1. Introduction to Jurisprudence – Legal positivism and Natural Law theory, Philosophies of Law/ Justice, Critical Legal studies, Feminist Jurisprudence
2. Anrthropological perspectives on Law – Legal Evolutionism, Relativism and Law, Legal Pluralism
3. The Political Economy of Law – Law and Ideology, Law and Power, Property and Law, Courts as Social Institutions
4. Law and Society in India – Historical Processes, Contemporary Concerns, India Constitution in Practise, Critical analysis of some judgments

Text Books :

1) Sarat, A. 2004. *The Blackwell Companion to Law and Society.* Oxford: Blackwells. (selected chapters).

Reference Books:

1. Freeman. M.D.A. (ed.). 2001 *Lloyd's Introduction to Jurisprudence. 7th ed.* London: Sweet and Maxwell. (Chapters 2,3,6,13,14, with selected extracts).
2. Kapur, Ratna (ed.). 1996. *Feminist Terrains in Legal Domains.* New Delhi: Kali for Women. (Chapter 4).
3. Cotterrell, R. (ed.). 2001. *Sociological Perspectives on Law.* Aldershot: Ashgate. (Vol. I & II, selected chapters).
4. Scheppele, K.L. 1994. Legal Theory and Social Theory, *Annual Review of Sociology* 20: 383-4065.
5. Moore, S.F. 2001. Certainties Undone: Fifty Turbulent Years of Legal Anthropology, 1949-1999, *Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute (NS)*, 7: 95-116.
6. Newman, K. 1983. *Law and Economic Organisation.* Cambridge: CUP, (Chapters 1-2).

Online Course Material

1. https://gian.iitkgp.ac.in/files/brochures/BR1449508690GIAN_brochure_Youth.pdf
2. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mJ8Pr5gIVCg&list=PLuRWUSe2BunHb_nXNK_o1OY__7HzD8g-J

Title	**Social Stratification**	Number	**LAL3090**
Department	HSS	L-T-P [C]	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	UG	Type	Elective
Prerequisite	None		

Objectives

The Instructor will:

1. To examine hierarchical differentiation that characterize human society
2. To analyse ideological and practical explanations offered to justify social inequalities
3. To identify the intersectionality that create and sustain social inequalities

Learning Outcomes

The students are expected to have the ability to:

1. Develop sensitivity to social inequality
2. Develop reflexivity and understand privilege
3. Address issues of social inequality while designing technical solutions

Contents

1. *Introduction: Concept and Theories* – Introduce the concept of social stratification and most significant theories around the concept (7 lectures)

2. *Forms of Stratification: Class* - Theories and empirical studies on class analysis and transformation of class structures (10 lectures)

3. *Forms of Stratification: Caste* – Theories on caste, Empirical studies with a focus on contemporary India. Caste in Labour markets. Export of caste (9 lectures)

4. *Stratification and Gender:* Gender inequalities, labour market and inequalities, intersectionality of Gender with class, caste and race (8 lectures)

5. *Race, Ethnicity and stratification* – Race and social inequality, Race and colonization (8 lectures)

Text Books: A handbook with all the study material will be given to the students.

Reference Books:

1. Gupta, D. ed. 1991. *Social Stratification.* Delhi: Oxford University Press.
2. Tumin, M. M. 1953. *Some Principles of Stratification: A Critical Analysis. American Sociological Review,* 18 (4): 387-94
3. Jodhka, S. S. 2012. *Caste. Oxford India Short Introductions.* Delhi: Oxford University Press
4. Acker, J. 1998. Women and Social Stratification: A Case of Intellectual Sexism, in *Feminist Foundations: Towards Transforming Sociology*, Kristen et. al. (ed.) Delhi: Sage.
4. Xaxa, V. 2003. 'Tribes in India' in Veena Das ed. Oxford India Companion to Sociology and Social Anthropology, 1: 373- 408. Delhi: Oxford University Press.

Online Course Material

1. https://www.coursera.org/lecture/classical-sociological-theory/2-6-social-stratification-neOzU

Course Title	**Digital Society**	Course No.	LAL3080
Department	SoLA	Structure (L-T-P [C])	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	Institute Humanities	Type	IH
Prerequisite	None		

Objectives

The Instructor will:

1. Introduce students to the dominant discourses that frame debates on digital society
2. Familiarize students with the literature pertaining to web technologies and their cultural, legal and ethical formations and practices
3. Familiarize students with the complex relationships between digital cultures and digital divides

Learning Outcomes

The students are expected to have the ability to:

1. Identify the ways in which digital media shape identity
2. Utilize new opportunities for meaningful data collection from and using sophisticated forms of artificial intelligence
3. Identify knowledge and truth amongst the abundance of information

Contents

Introduction to Digital Society: Digital components of a connected society (4 lectures)
Theorizing Digital Society: New forms of power; Data as sociomaterial objects; Archives; Digital veillance (7 lectures)
Digital Identities and Relationships: Self and the Digital Society; Embodied Identities in Digital Society; Bias and Privilege – Digital Inequalities; Marginalised Histories**;** Cyborgs (7 lectures)
Digital Spaces and Practices: Rethinking space and surveillance in digital societies; Gender, Space, and Place in Digital Societies**;** Urban Informatics and Sociological Imagination -Smart cities**;** Digital Healthcare; Mobility in Digital Society; Digital Heritage (8 lectures)
Network Society: The Internet as a Network; Networks and the Cultural Imaginary; Inequalities in the Network Society; Information Capital; Interface Design for Diverse Populations (8 lectures)
Re-conceptualizing Research in a Digital Age: Information Management – Data Analysis Software**;** Large Digital Systems; Data protection and the politics of data privacy (7 lectures)

Textbook

1. Lupton,D., (2015), *Digital Sociology*, London, New York: Routledge
2. Gere,C., (2008), *Digital Culture*, 2nd Edition, London: Reaktion Books Limited

Reference Books

1. Bentkowska-Kafel, A., Cashen, T., and Gardiner, H. (Eds.) (2009), *Digital Visual Culture: Theory and Practice*, Bristol and Chicago: Intellect Books
2. Karaganis, J. (Ed.), (2007), *Structures of Participation in Digital Culture*, Social Science Research Council, Columbia University Press

3. Tredinnick, L. (2008), *Digital Information Culture: The Individual and Society in the Digital Age*, Oxford: Chandos Publishing Limited

Online Resources

1. Digital Humanities Seminar Video Archive of the Open University, UK, http://www.open.ac.uk/arts/research/digital-humanities/videos

Course Title	**Gender and Society**	Course No.	LAL3130
Department	SoLA	Structure (L-T-P [C])	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	Institute Humanities	Type	Elective
Prerequisite	None		

Objectives

1. To provide conceptual, sociological tools and skillset for critiquing binary and ahistorical conceptions of gender
2. To offer critical understanding of gender in a globalized, transnational world
3. To offer critical understanding of gender representations in media, visual cultures, and technology

Learning Outcomes

1. Critique binary and ahistorical conceptions of gender in society
2. Understand interrelatedness of local, global, and transnational contexts in shaping of gender issues
3. Accept of shared responsibility for solving local and global experiences of gender Inequality

Contents

Gender as social construction: Key concepts; Introductions; Historical and social constructions of gender (3 lectures);
Gender in Colonial History (6 lectures)
Gender across geo-social scales - Politics of the body; Marriage and the Family; Gender and the Nation; Gender and Migration (6 lectures)
Feminisms - History and types of feminist movements; Transnational Feminisms (6 lectures)
Gender, Science, and Technology - History of gender in science and technology; Household technologies; Medical technologies; Communication technologies; Video Games (7 lectures)
Imagining and Representing Gender - Gender in Literature and Culture (3 lectures); Postcolonial Studies; Gender and "modernity" (4 lectures);
Normativity, Subversions, and Queer Studies (4 lectures);
Global Gender Politics (3 lectures)

References

1. Enloe, C. (2014) Bananas, Beaches and Bases: Making Feminist Sense of International Politics, University of California Press, 2014
2. Fausto-Sterling, A. (2012) Sex / Gender: Biology in a Social World. Routledge, ISBN: 9780415881463
3. Grewal, I. and Kaplan, C. (1994), Scattered Hegemonies: Postmodernity and

Transnational Feminist Practices, University of Minnesota Press, ISBN 10: 0816621381; ISBN 13: 9780816621385
4. Mohun, A. Ed., (2003), Gender and Technology: A Reader. Baltimore, MD: Johns Hopkins University Press, ISBN: 9780801872594
5. Sangari, K. and Vaid S., (1989), Recasting Women: Essays in Colonial History. Rutgers University Press ISBN-10: 0813515807; ISBN-13: 978-0813515809

Online resources

1. Gender, Sexuality, and Society: https://ocw.mit.edu/courses/anthropology/21a-231j-gender-sexuality-and- society-spring-2006/index.htm
2. Gender and Technology: https://ocw.mit.edu/courses/womens-and-gender-studies/wgs-115-gender-and- technology-spring-2013/index.htm
3. Women's and Gender Studies (list of all courses): https://ocw.mit.edu/courses/womens-and-gender-studies/100

Course Title	**Introduction to Sociology**	Course No.	**LAL3030**
Department	HSS	Structure (L-T-P-C)	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	UG	Type	Elective
Pre-requisite	None		

Objectives

1. To introduce basic sociological perspectives to understanding the world
2. To help students examine their own social experiences from a scientifically inquisitive perspective
3. To understand how one's social position within unequal societies allows for different kinds of expression of selfhood and varied life experience.

Learning Outcomes

1. Develop a holistic understanding of sociological perspectives
2. Apply sociological concepts, terms, and theories to the processes of everyday life
3. Identify historical contexts that have shaped (and continue to shape) social constructions of inequalities and social stratifications, such as race, ethnicity, gender, social status, economic class, and religion

Contents

Introduction: What is Sociology? Why study Sociology (5 lectures); Sociological Theories and Perspectives (5 lectures)
Social Structures, Social Processes, and Social Institutions: Social Stratifications (Ethnicity, Race, Caste, Gender, Social Class) (6 lectures); Intimate Relations (Marriage and the Family); Social Institutions (Education; Religion; Economy); Social Inequalities (Poverty and Inequality); Social Processes (Migrations and other mobilities) (6 lectures)
Community, Globalisation and Environment: Urban Sociology (5 lectures); Transnational Corporate Power, and the Environment (6 lectures)
People, Places, and Technology: Science as a social process(4 lectures); Sociologies of Medicine and Healthcare; Technology, Networks, and Image representations (5 lectures)

Text Books

1. Deshpande,S., *Contemporary India: Sociological Perspectives*, Viking, 2003
2. Macionis,J. J., and Plummer K., *Sociology: A Global Introduction*, Prentice Hall, 2012
3. Weber,M., *Basic Concepts in Sociology*, Citadel Press, 1993

NPTEL Resources

1. Introduction to Sociology, Sambit Mallick, IIT Guwahati, http://nptel.ac.in/courses/109103023/
2. Understanding Cultural Studies Part I, Liza Das, IIT Guwahati, http://nptel.ac.in/courses/109103019/
3. Indian Society: Issues and Problems, Sambit Mallick, Liza Das, IIT Guwahati, http://nptel.ac.in/courses/109103022/
4. Science, Technology, and Society, Sambit Mallick, Archana Barua, IIT Guwahati, http://nptel.ac.in/courses/109103024/
5. Population and Society, A.K. Sharma, IIT Kanpur, http://nptel.ac.in/courses/109104044/

Title	**Development and Environment**	Number	LAL3060
Department	SoLA	L-T-P [C]	3-0-0 [3]
Offered for	B.Tech	Type	Elective
Prerequisite	None		

Objectives

The Instructor will:

1. Provide a critical understanding of the way development discourse is conceptualized and contested in social sciences literature.
2. Introduce students to the debates on development and environment and help them better understand the contemporary issues in the field of environmental paradigms.
3. Facilitate students to understand different perspectives on development policy and environmental governance, especially in the socio-historical and political context of India.

Learning Outcomes

The students are expected to have the ability to:

1. Interpret the theories and concepts underlying the principles and practices of environment, sustainable development and natural resource management.
2. Develop the capacity to participate in debates on development and environmental discourses and governance.
3. By the end of the course, students will be able to understand the development and environmental policies and prepare them for further research in these areas.

Contents

Historical Location of the Idea of Development: Perspective from the Third World (2 lectures)
Dominant Development Paradigm and its critique (5 lectures)
Theories and Actors in Development Politics: State, Civil society, Market Forces, International, National and Local Levels (5 lectures)
History of development in India across space and time: experiences, policies, achievements, and development projects, development-induced displacement in Indian context (5 lectures)
Environmental historical discourse of India across space and time (3 lectures)
Environmental Paradigms: Theoretical and Empirical Perspectives from India and Global South (6 lectures)
Gender and Environment: Feminist political ecology, environmental movements and case studies from global South (4 lectures)
Natural Resource Management and Role of Local Communities: use, access, management, and technology issues, recent conflict over natural resources (6 lectures)
Sustainable Development and Environment Research: challenge of sustainable development, and a way forward (3 lectures)

Textbook: A handbook with all the study material will be given to the students.

Reference Books

1. McMichael, P. (2016) *Development and social change: a global perspective,* London: Sage.
2. Webster, A. (1984) *Introduction to the sociology of development*, Macmillan.
3. Dube, S. C. (1988) *Modernisation and development: search for alternative paradigms*. New Delhi: Vistaar Publications.
4.Guha, R. (2000), *Environmentalism: a global history*. Delhi: Oxford University Press.
5.Gadgil, M. and G, Ramachandra. (2014) This fissured land: an ecological history of India, New Delhi: OUP.

Online Course Material

1. https://www.coursera.org/learn/sustainable-development#about